

Eyes in the Sky: Australia's Growing Space Industry

NAPLAN-Style Informational Reading Worksheet

Year 6 English

ACARA: AC9E6LY03

AC9E6LY05 | AC9E6LY06

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: ____ / 20

Learning Intention: I can analyse an informational text, infer meaning, evaluate evidence and justify my answers using details from the passage.

Reading Strategy**Read like a detective - underline facts, circle key words and use evidence.**

Reading Passage

When people think about space, they often imagine astronauts floating inside spacecraft or rockets launching into the night sky. However, space technology is also part of everyday life on Earth. In Australia, satellites help people check the weather, navigate roads, manage farms, communicate across long distances and monitor changes in the environment.

Australia has a long connection with space. Its wide open landscapes and clear skies have made it a useful place for tracking satellites and spacecraft. Today, the nation's space industry is growing in new ways. Scientists, engineers and businesses are developing small satellites, ground stations, sensors and software that can collect and interpret information from above the planet.

Satellites travel in orbit around Earth. From this position, they can observe large areas that would be difficult to study from the ground. A satellite image might show the spread of bushfire smoke, the health of crops, flooding after heavy rain or changes along a coastline. This information can help emergency services, farmers, researchers and local councils make better decisions.

Space technology also supports communication. In remote parts of Australia, where towns may be far apart, satellite connections can help people access phone, internet and emergency information. This is especially important during natural disasters, when ordinary communication systems may be damaged.

The growing space industry needs many different skills. Some workers design hardware, while others write code, analyse data or manage projects. Not every space job involves becoming an astronaut. Many roles are based on Earth and focus on solving practical problems for communities.

There are challenges too. Launching equipment is expensive, and space debris can create risks for working satellites. People also need to think carefully about privacy and the responsible use of data. As the industry grows, clear rules and smart planning will be important.

Australia's space future is not only about exploring distant planets. It is also about using information from above to make life safer, smarter and more sustainable here at home. For students interested in science, technology, engineering or mathematics, the sky may no longer be the limit.

Reading Comprehension Questions

Answer from easy to hard. Use evidence from the passage where needed.

Section A Multiple choice

1. What is the main purpose of the passage?
- ☐ To entertain with a fictional adventure
- ☐ To explain an issue and possible responses
- ☐ To list random facts
- ☐ To persuade readers to avoid all technology

Section B Find the facts

2. Identify two facts from the passage that show why the topic matters.
-
-
3. Name one person, group or technology involved in solving the problem.
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Section C

Vocabulary

4. In the passage, what does 'orbit' most nearly mean?
- ☐ The path an object takes around another object
- ☐ A deep ocean
- ☐ A cooking method
- ☐ A type of rainforest

Author's Purpose

5. Why did the author include specific examples or data in the passage?
-
-

Section D Inference

6. What can you infer about why space technology is useful even for people who never travel to space?
-
-
7. Write one question you still have after reading this text.

- ☐ Evidence used
- ☐ Key vocabulary
- ☐ Clear opinion
- ☐ Capital letters & full stops
- ☐ Answer checked

High Five! You're a Reading Comprehension Superstar!

☐ Vocabulary ☐ Inference ☐ Evidence Response - All done = Reader Award in Pet Town!

Teacher / Parent Feedback

Well done for...

Next step...

Star Rating: ☆☆☆☆☆

Teacher & Parent Guide

Eyes in the Sky: Australia's Growing Space Industry - Year 6 Reading

Curriculum Alignment - ACARA v9.0

AC9E6LY03 - Analyse how text structures and language features work together to meet the purpose of a text.

AC9E6LY05 - Use comprehension strategies to interpret and analyse information and ideas.

AC9E6LY06 - Create written responses using evidence from texts.

Answer Key & Sample Responses

Question	Expected Response / Marking Guide	Marks
1	To explain how Australia's space industry supports everyday life and decision-making.	2
2	Accept facts about weather, navigation, farms, communication, bushfires, floods or jobs.	4
3	Satellites, ground stations, sensors, software, engineers, farmers, emergency services.	2
4	Orbit means the path an object takes around another object.	1
5	Examples show space technology is practical and useful on Earth.	3
6	Satellites support weather, navigation, communication, farming and emergency response.	4
7	Accept a relevant question about satellites, space jobs, data, privacy or space debris.	1

Differentiation Strategies

Support / Foundation

- Read passage aloud
- Highlight key words
- Answer Sections A-B
- Use sentence frames

At Level / Year 6

- Complete all sections
- Use evidence
- Explain vocabulary
- Self-check answers

Extension / Advanced

- Compare with another text
- Research a real example
- Write a balanced response
- Create an infographic

Fun Aussie Activities at Home

Sky Search

Look up one Australian place connected to space science.

Satellite Spot

List three ways satellites help your family or community.

STEM Talk

Discuss one space job that does not involve being an astronaut.

Design Task

Design a small satellite that solves an Australian problem.